Procurement Integrity Investigation Playbook

Standard operating procedure for triaging and investigating procurement integrity alerts in SAS Visual Investigator · Knowledge base v1.0

1. Purpose and scope

This playbook governs how procurement integrity alerts raised by detection scenarios are triaged, investigated, and dispositioned. It applies to all alerts on suppliers, tenders, purchase orders, invoices, and payments in the monitored procurement environment. An alert is an indicator that patterns associated with integrity risk were detected — it is never, by itself, a finding of wrongdoing.

2. Alert triage workflow

- **Step 1 — Prioritize.** Work the queue highest score first. An alert's score is the roll-up of its contributing scenario-fired events; always review the scorecard to see which scenarios drive it.
- **Step 2 — Understand the evidence.** Read every scenario-fired event behind the alert: which detection fired, on which records, with which values. Compare against the red-flags reference to understand what the pattern typically indicates.
- **Step 3 — Profile the entity.** Review the flagged entity's full record, its history, and prior investigator comments. Check whether the entity has prior alerts and how they were dispositioned.
- **Step 4 — Map the network.** Expand the entity's relationship network (directors, addresses, bank accounts, related suppliers, tenders, and payments). Look for undisclosed connections between suppliers and evaluators, shared infrastructure between competing bidders, and hub entities linking multiple flagged records.
- **Step 5 — Corroborate.** Verify key facts against source systems and, where policy allows, external sources (registries, sanctions and adverse-media checks).
- **Step 6 — Disposition.** Choose a disposition per section 4 and record the rationale in a comment. Escalate when any escalation criterion in section 5 is met.

3. Score interpretation bands

Score band	Priority	Expected handling
80–100	Critical	Begin triage within 4 business hours; notify the team lead on assignment.
60–79	High	Triage within 1 business day.
40–59	Medium	Triage within 3 business days.
Below 40	Low	Batch review weekly; candidates for auto-disposition when the only scenario is a known benign pattern.

4. Dispositions

Disposition	Use when
Close — false positive	The evidence has a verified benign explanation. Record the explanation; recurring false positives should be reported for scenario tuning.
Close — low risk	The pattern is real but immaterial (below threshold amounts, one-off timing artefacts).

Monitor	Suspicion is not resolved but evidence is insufficient; keep the entity under observation.
Escalate to investigation	Escalation criteria met; a case and workflow are opened and the alert is assigned.
Refer	The matter belongs to another function (HR, legal, vendor management); hand over with a summary.

5. Escalation criteria

- Estimated exposure exceeds AED 250,000 on a single supplier or tender, or AED 1,000,000 aggregated across related entities.
- Two or more independent scenario types fire on the same entity within 90 days.
- The network review reveals an undisclosed link between a supplier and an employee involved in the award decision.
- Any indication of document falsification or identity manipulation.
- A sanctioned or debarred party appears in the entity's network.

6. Documentation standard

Every disposition must carry a comment answering three questions: what fired and why, what was checked, and why the chosen disposition follows. Investigation quality is audited against this standard quarterly.